



Multiverse of Madness on Disney+

Doctor Strange: Multiverse of Madness is making its way to Disney+ on 22 June.
<https://digit.in/jun22-93>



MSI GT77 is almost here!

MSI announces its newest laptop GT77 with a 4K screen and 250W combined power.
<https://digit.in/jun22-94>

Realme Buds Air 3

A budget all-rounder like no other

Realme has built a formidable portfolio of audio products with majority of them meeting or surpassing our expectations. Naturally, we were excited to try out Realme's latest Buds Air 3 earphones. The buds come packing a plethora of improvements over its predecessor, but how does this translate in real life? Let's find out.

BUILD AND FIT

The Realme Buds Air 3 looks almost identical to its predecessor – the Buds Air 2. The case has the same cobble-shaped design with the exception of a shiny glass-like finish on the top with the Realme logo stamped on top.

The case is lightweight, pocketable and easy to open one-handed. The magnets that hold the earbuds inside the case are sufficiently strong. The case's hinge feels robust enough for the price, but there's no metallic reinforcement.

The earbuds have a long stem with a metallic look that is pretty different from the status quo. The stems also house touch sensors for call and music playback controls. The controls work reliably, for the most part.

As for fit and comfort, the company has provided three different sizes of silicone eartips that should provide most users with a snug fit. We would be comfortable recommending these earbuds to fitness enthusiasts, especially due to the IPX5 rating.

FEATURES

You'd be hard-pressed to find a pair of truly wireless earbuds more feature-rich than the Realme Buds Air 3 under 4K. The feature that will grab most eyeballs is, of course, Active Noise Cancellation. The updated Realme R3 chip does an excellent job at mitigating ambient noise and providing a cocoon of silence. Not only do the earbuds diminish low-end, constant sounds such as an AC's hum or an airplane's



drone, but it also drowns out human voices and other high frequency sounds considerably.

The earbuds also come with Transparency Mode support that amplifies surrounding sounds.

The next best feature is app support via the versatile Realme Link app. The app allows users to access a wide array of features and controls that enhance the overall user experience. The app allows you to check battery levels, change noise cancellation modes, activate wind noise reduction for calls, choose between preset EQ profiles, toggle Game Mode, activate multipoint connection or dual-device connection, perform earbud fit test, and customise controls.

Our favourite feature on these earbuds, by far, is multipoint connection which has to be activated via the app. Turn this on, and you can connect the earbuds to two source devices simultaneously and transition seamlessly between them.

PERFORMANCE

Equipped with a 10mm LCP dynamic driver, the Realme Buds Air 3 provides a pleasant, V-shaped sound signature that works well with most popular genres of music. The sound signature differs from its predecessor in some

ways; the mids and highs are more boosted in comparison to the Realme Buds Air 2. Now, while the boosted mids inject some much-needed detail and clarity to vocals and mid-range instruments, the boosted highs tend to sound slightly tinny and shrill, in some cases.

The earphones come equipped with dual AI noise-cancelling microphones that work together to reduce environmental sound during calls. In our testing, we found that the microphone quality was pretty good for calls, both indoors and outdoors. The long stems mean that the microphones are closer to your mouth, allowing the earbuds to catch your voice better.

BATTERY LIFE

The Realme Buds Air 3 impresses when it comes to battery life. Not only do you get 30 hours of total playback time, but you can also charge the earphones for merely 10 minutes to get 100 minutes of wireless playback time. In our tests, the earbuds lasted for

5 hours with ANC turned on and the volume set to 70 per cent.

VERDICT

While we preferred the more balanced sound quality of the Realme Buds Air 2 compared to the Buds Air 3, the earphones still have a pleasant sound signature that works well with most popular genres of music. That aside, what makes the Realme Buds Air 3 stand out is its colossal feature set. It is, without an ounce of doubt, one of the best TWS you can purchase under 4K.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

DRIVER SIZE: 10mm | AUDIO CODECS: AAC, SBC | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.2 | WATER RESISTANCE: IPX5 (earbuds only) | BATTERY LIFE (CASE): 22 hours with Noise Cancellation, 30 hours without Noise Cancellation | BATTERY LIFE (EARBUDS): 5.5 hours with Noise Cancellation, 7 hours without Noise Cancellation

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